

My Involvement with Entrepreneurship Ecosystem in Arlington, Texas, United States of America — 76013

“When life doesn’t give you lemons, Go Find them, make lemonade, and sell it.” — Me.

Because of e-DAM, I started to grow out of my undergrad college (Institute of Aeronautical Engineering), in Hyderabad, India. I met many people in TASK and T-Hub. Met a few start-ups founders, and was involved with them. One of them, I still am contact with is Shivaganesh Gaddam.

Being in this ecosystem, made me more smart, intellectual growth, and improved my mindset.

When I moved to United States for the first time in the last week of July 2023. I wanted to be in the same ecosystem. TBH, I didn’t research much about the city I was moving to, until and after I did, I regretted. I was busy with Social Media Summit 2023, Hyderabad. I will be writing a blog about it soon. I got admission in University of Texas at Arlington, for my Master’s program.



As soon as I came to the city, the first thing I felt was, Different. Different City, Different People, Different Ecosystem, Different Culture, Different Environment, Different Friends, Different **Conversations**, Different Transportation, Different Food, and more. I was not ready for this. Suddenly, I fell from having **business conversations** from my contacts from T-Hub to no one in Arlington.

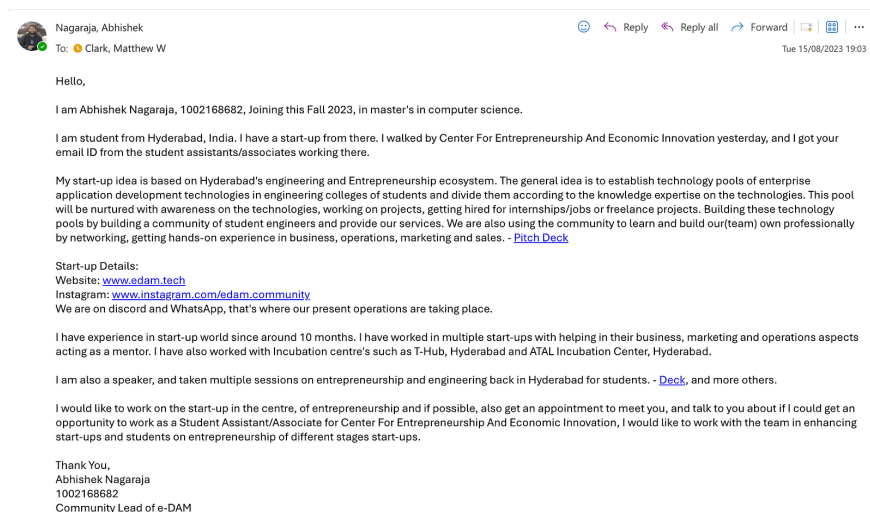
Book 3, Chapter 1: Student Ambassador

Then, I came across Center For Entrepreneurship and Technology Development (Back then it was, Center For Entrepreneurship and Economics Innovation). I met Josue Melendez, Gokul Suryanarayanan and Yusra Razak, for the first time in the building.



That's when I wrote an email on August 15th to Matt Clark, which started my first Entrepreneurship Chapter in United States. I joined CETD, in October 2023. I worked there for 2 years. Worked with awesome people, including Paul Corson, Kara Johnson, and many others.

Two Other Alumnus I met while working here who has helped me and endorsed me are Hayden Blackburn and Scott Parsinfien. They are awesome.



Chapter Two: Entrepreneurship Club UTA

I wanted to start Entrepreneurship Club UTA. (Building Communities became my thing). There wasn't one until covid. While it was very difficult for me to communicate with the people, which was not a problem in India, but I started feeling shy or god knows what reason, I needed to build a team, in process I met Intesar Husain. I could say, the first like-minded person I met in United States. He has an Entrepreneurial Mindset. We took around 4 months to find members to run the club, and start programs. The first semester was pretty much just Him and I. The next semester joined a few members, and didn't work out, and left. We still continued with our speaker programs. On an average we had around 6–8 people show up to our events, and no one in a few other events.

In process, I met an alumni who has helped me so much in way of expanding Entrepreneurship Club and MavMarket, and that's David Nguyen. He has been doing an amazing job of connecting the Entrepreneurship Club to his start-up network, and helped me personally multiple times.

We start the Where's The Funding(WTF) Speaker Series, we chose 3 sectors a semester, invite a few speakers from the sectors to talk to the students. We had a few more students, and then we passed it on to SK Chaitanya after one and a half year of running it as President, and Intesar as Vice President.



Entrepreneurship Club Team Spring 2025

Chapter Three: MavMarket

A big step in the journey. UTA's Student Marketplace.

Matt and I were speaking on ways to expand the Entrepreneurship Club, and in the efforts, we spoke about a vendor pop-up for students. There are many student in UTA who set up pop-ups at the University Center and Library who sell keychains, earnings, and many more. Many more which we didn't know until we organized the first MavMarket in Spring 2024 with the help of the team from CETD. It was literally a leap. The only research we did was talk to the students who set up pop-ups on campus. It was a big hit. 60 vendors, \$15,000 approx cumulative revenue in one day.

It's a big deal for me, and it continued the next semester with 98 vendors, and \$40,000 approx cumulative revenue in Fall 2024.

Again, Spring 2025, 130 vendors, \$60,000 approx cumulative revenue.

Imagine, yourself, as a non-immigrant student with all the different things I was feeling, and working on something like this, which is and will be impacting for the students of the University of Texas at Arlington, and City of Arlington, I am very proud of it. (It might not look from a third-person perspective.)

David Nguyen introduced me to Oscar Escajeda and Alex. Their start-up OTI, Simplifying Local Discovery, became a part of MavMarket and sponsored the events to come.

I stopped acting as the lead organizer after Spring 2025, and Chaitanya and Team Continued MavMarket from Fall 2025.



Spring 2025 MavMarket Team.

Chapter Four: 1 Million Cups, Arlington

In Spring 2025, Matt, Josue and I with a few more organizers, started 1 Million Cups Arlington, TX.

Another big step in my journey of Entrepreneurship in The USA. Every Wednesday Morning at 9:00 AM, Caffeinating Entrepreneurs Nationwide with Presentation and Connections.

I loved this environment. This is what I was craving for since the first time I came to United States. Entrepreneurs and Businessmen in one place, talking about changing the world, and making money. I met really super people on the way.

A few noted, Pamela Cytron (The Founders' Arena), Clay White (Casablanca Cocktails), Scott Parsinen (I knew Scott through UTA

CETD itself, he is an alumni), Vijay Mehra (Lenderbox AI), Erin Clark, Whitney Gardner, and many more.

A few start-ups which caught my interest were: OTI, Market Match, NeuroLocker Corporation, Cultured, That Menu App, numbrU, College Cash, and obviously many more.

Chapter Five: Casablanca Cocktails